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(54) SKI PROTECTION DEVICE

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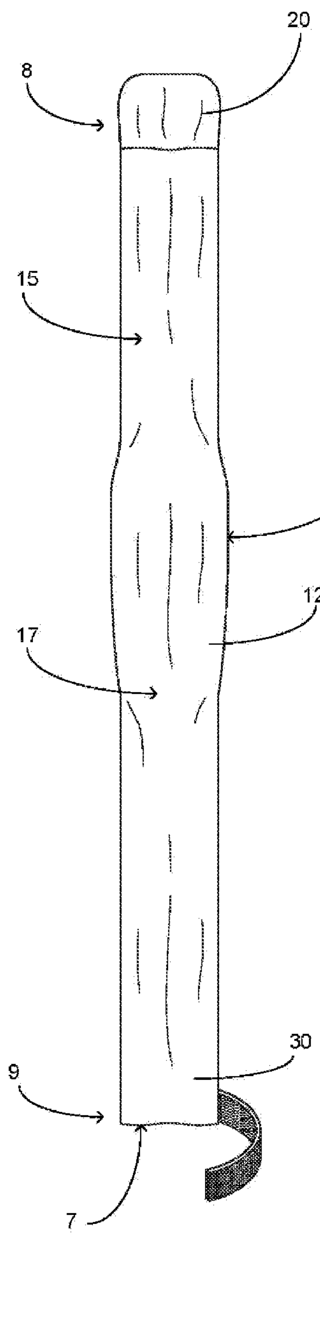
(57) **ABSTRACT**

A ski protection device that is configured to be surroundably mounted to a snow ski so as to provide protection thereof wherein the present invention further facilitates an ability for a user to transport the snow ski while encased in the present invention on a conventional roof rack. The present invention includes a body having a wall member manufactured from nylon or similar material that creates an interior volume suitable for disposing a snow ski therein. The body of the present invention includes a first portion and a second portion contiguously formed wherein the second portion has a width greater than that of the first portion. Proximate the second end of the body is an end portion. The end portion is movable to a second position wherein the end portion is folded back over to be adjacent the second end of the body and secured thereto utilizing a strap member.



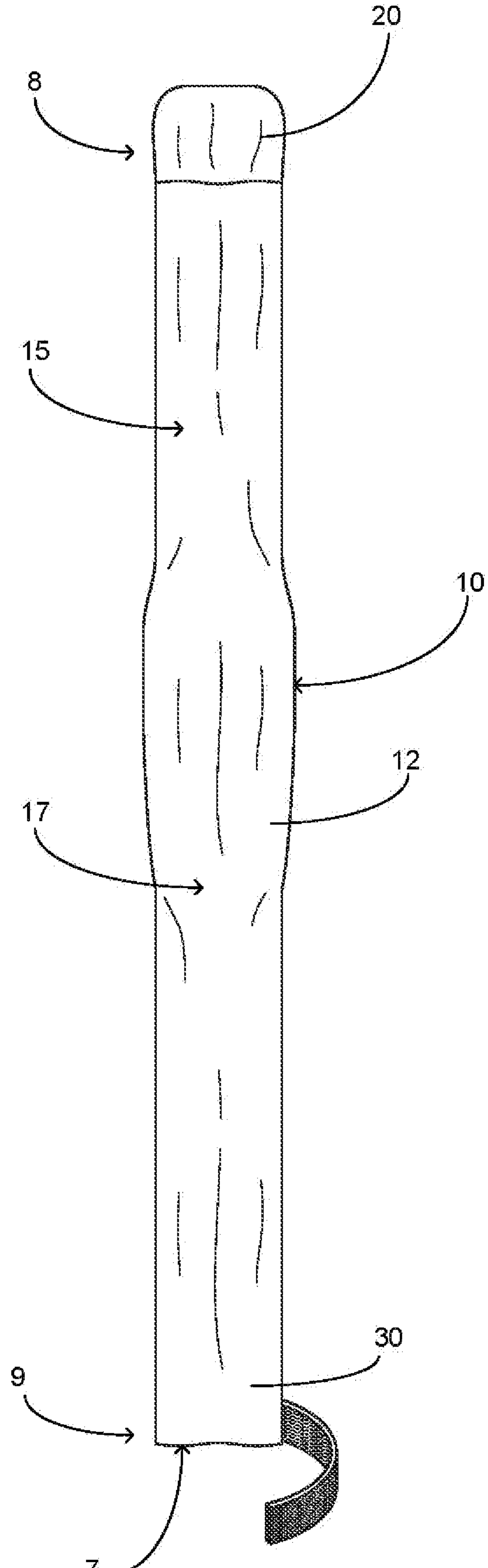


FIG. 1

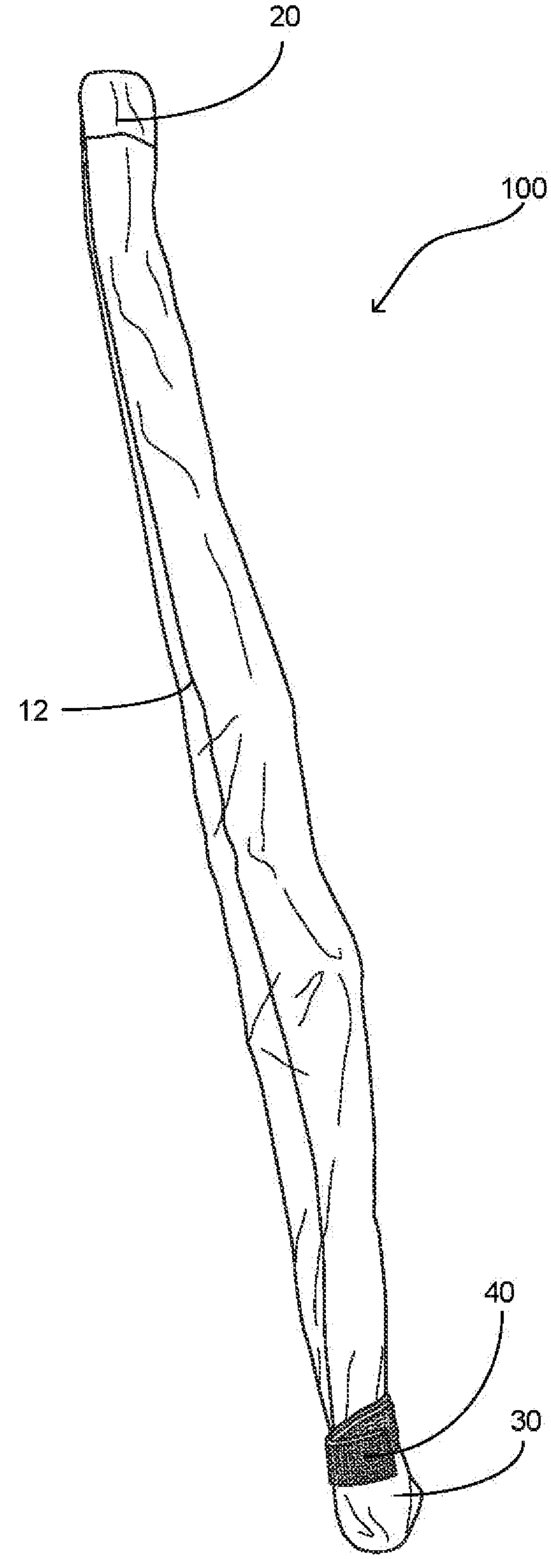


FIG. 2

SKI PROTECTION DEVICE

FIELD OF THE INVENTION

[0001] The present invention relates generally to protective devices, more specifically but not by way of limitation, a protective device that is configured to have a single snow ski disposed therein wherein the present invention inhibits damage to the ski and facilitates an ability to be stored on apparatus such as but not limited to ski roof racks in a normal operational position.

BACKGROUND

[0002] Tens of thousands of individuals regularly participate in the sport of snow skiing. Snow skis are often a significant investment and can cost thousands of dollars just for the skis. Skiers must also make investments in other accessories such as but not limited to boots and poles. Snow skis are manufactured wherein the snow ski consists of a core material, wood or synthetic, and has several laminate layers of different material on each side of the core. Skis will have steel edge members and the base layer is often graphite or similar material. Fiberglass and other materials are employed to make the layers and the outermost layer on the upper surface of the ski is often referred to as the topsheet layer.

[0003] Many skiers will travel with their skis and there are protection bags that are commonly available to carry two skis. These types of bags require that the two skis are clamped together with the bottoms of the two skis being adjacent. While these bags effectively protect the skis during travel by plane and other means, they are unable to stay surroundably mounted to a ski when utilizing a roof rack. As is known in the art, ski roof racks are secured to the top of motor vehicles and a single ski is place on a bottom portion with a top portion clamping the ski in place. These roof racks provide a convenient way to transport skis but expose the skis to debris, dirt and other contaminants that have a negative impact to the overall condition of the ski.

[0004] Accordingly, there is a need for a ski protection device that can accommodate a single ski therein wherein the present invention allows utilization of equipment such as but not limited to ski roof racks while being disposed in the ski protection device of the present invention so as to inhibit damage to the ski during transport thereof.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

[0005] It is the object of the present invention to provide a ski protection device that is configured to have a single snow ski disposed therein wherein the present invention includes a body having a wall member forming an interior volume suitable in size to accommodate a snow ski therein.

[0006] Another object of the present invention is to provide a protection device for a snow ski that is configured to surroundably mount a snow ski wherein the body includes a first portion and a second portion integrally formed.

[0007] A further object of the present invention is to provide a ski protection device that is configured to have a single snow ski disposed therein wherein the second portion of the body has a width greater than the first portion.

[0008] Yet a further object of the present invention is to provide a protection device for a snow ski that is configured to surroundably mount a snow ski wherein the second portion further includes an end portion wherein the end portion is operable to be folded back over onto the second portion proximate thereto.

[0009] Still another object of the present invention is to provide a ski protection device that is configured to have a single snow ski disposed therein wherein the end portion includes a securing member fastened thereto.

[0010] An additional object of the present invention is to provide a protection device for a snow ski that is configured to surroundably mount a snow ski wherein the first portion of the body includes an end member distal to the end portion wherein the end member is constructed to inhibit a ski tip from propagating therethrough.

[0011] Yet a further object of the present invention is to provide a ski protection device that is configured to have a single snow ski disposed wherein the body is manufactured from a material such as but not limited to nylon.

[0012] To the accomplishment of the above and related objects the present invention may be embodied in the form illustrated in the accompanying drawings. Attention is called to the fact that the drawings are illustrative only. Variations are contemplated as being a part of the present invention, limited only by the scope of the claims.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0013] A more complete understanding of the present invention may be had by reference to the following Detailed Description and appended claims when taken in conjunction with the accompanying Drawings wherein:

[0014] FIG. **1** is a top view of an embodiment of the present invention; and

[0015] FIG. **2** is a perspective view of the present invention with the end portion in its second position.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0016] Referring now to the drawings submitted herewith, wherein various elements depicted therein are not necessarily drawn to scale and wherein through the views and figures like elements are referenced with identical reference numerals, there is illustrated a ski protection device **100** constructed according to the principles of the present invention.

[0017] An embodiment of the present invention is discussed herein with reference to the figures submitted herewith. Those skilled in the art will understand that the detailed description herein with respect to these figures is for explanatory purposes and that it is contemplated within the scope of the present invention that alternative embodiments are plausible. By way of example but not by way of limitation, those having skill in the art in light of the present teachings of the present invention will recognize a plurality of alternate and suitable approaches dependent upon the needs of the particular application to implement the functionality of any given detail described herein, beyond that of the particular implementation choices in the embodiment described herein. Various modifications and embodiments are within the scope of the present invention.

[0018] It is to be further understood that the present invention is not limited to the particular methodology, materials, uses and applications described herein, as these may vary. Furthermore, it is also to be understood that the terminology used herein is used for the purpose of describing particular embodiments only, and is not intended to limit the scope of the present invention. It must be noted that as used herein and in the claims, the singular forms "a", "an" and "the" include the plural reference unless the context clearly dictates otherwise. Thus, for example, a reference to "an element" is a reference to one or more elements and includes equivalents thereof known to those skilled in the art. All conjunctions used are to be understood in the most inclusive sense possible. Thus, the word "or" should be understood as having the definition of a logical "or" rather than that of a logical "exclusive or" unless the context clearly necessitates otherwise. Structures described herein are to be understood also to refer to functional equivalents of such structures. Language that may be construed to express approximation should be so understood unless the context clearly dictates otherwise.

[0019] References to "one embodiment", "an embodiment", "exemplary embodiments", and the like may indicate that the embodiment(s) of the invention so described may include a particular feature, structure or characteristic, but not every embodiment necessarily includes the particular feature, structure or characteristic.

[0020] Referring in particular to the Figures submitted herewith, the ski protection device **100** includes a body **10** wherein the body **10** is formed from wall member **12**. The wall member **12** is formed so as to create an interior volume such that the body **10** can accommodate a single snow ski within the interior volume of the body **10**. The body **10** includes a first end **8** and a second end **9** having an opening **7** at the second end **9**. It should be understood within the scope of the present invention that the length of the body **10** is suitable to accommodate a snow ski completely within the interior volume of the body **10**. While the ski protection device **100** is discussed herein being employed for a snow ski, it should be understood within the scope of the present invention that the present invention could be utilized for other objects such as but not limited to snowboards.

[0021] The body **10** is comprised of a first portion **15** and a second portion **17** wherein the first portion **15** and second portion **17** are contiguous and integrally formed. The second portion **17** has a width that is greater than that of the width of the first portion **15**. The second portion **17** is constructed with a greater width so as to accommodate bindings and other mechanical elements that are typically secured to the upper surface of a snow ski. The first end **8** has formed thereon an end member **20**. End member **20** is integrally formed onto the body **10** utilizing suitable durable techniques such as but not limited to stitching. The end member **20** is manufactured from a heavier material than the body **10** so as to inhibit a tip of a snow ski from being able to penetrate through the body **10** at the first end **8** thereof. It is contemplated within the scope of the present invention that the end member **20** could be disposed within the interior volume of the body **10** and on the exterior as illustrated herein. Furthermore, it is additionally contemplated within the scope of the present invention that the end member **20** could be provided in alternate sizes and be manufactured from various suitable materials.

[0022] Proximate the second end **9** of the body **10** is end portion **30**. In a preferred embodiment of the present invention the end portion **30** extends beyond the rear end of a snow ski ensuing the snow ski being inserted into the interior volume of the body **10**. The end portion **30** is movable to its second position, illustrated herein in FIG. **2**, wherein the end portion **30** is adjacent the body **10** proximate the second end **9** thereof. In its second position the end portion **30** is secured with strap member **40**. Strap member **40** is configured to surroundably mount the end portion **30** and second end **9** of the body **10** so as to releasably secure the end portion **30** in its second position. In a preferred embodiment of the present invention the strap member **40** is manufactured from hook and loop material but it is contemplated within the scope of the present invention that the strap member **40** could be manufactured from alternate suitable materials. It is contemplated within the scope of the present invention that the end portion **30** could remain in its first position subsequent installation of a snow ski having a length equivalent to that of the body **10** wherein the strap member **40** would be utilized to cinch the end portion **30** closed.

[0023] While the preferred embodiment is configured to provide protection of a snow ski while further allowing for use of conventional transportation devices such as but not limited to roof racks, it should be understood within the scope of the present invention that alternate objects could be placed within the present invention so as to provide protection thereof.

[0024] In the preceding detailed description, reference has been made to the accompanying drawings that form a part hereof, and in which are shown by way of illustration specific embodiments in which the invention may be practiced. These embodiments, and certain variants thereof, have been described in sufficient detail to enable those skilled in the art to practice the invention. It is to be understood that other suitable embodiments may be utilized and that logical changes may be made without departing from the spirit or scope of the invention. The description may omit certain information known to those skilled in the art. The preceding detailed description is, therefore, not intended to be limited to the specific forms set forth herein, but on the contrary, it is intended to cover such alternatives, modifications, and equivalents, as can be reasonably included within the spirit and scope of the appended claims.

What is claimed is:

1. A ski protection device that is configured to inhibit debris from contacting a ski during transport wherein the ski protection device comprises:

a body, said body having a wall member wherein said wall member is constructed to form an interior volume, said body having a first end and a second end, said second end of said body having an opening providing access to said interior volume of said body, said body being comprised of a first portion and a second portion, said first portion and said second portion of said body being contiguously formed;

an end portion, said end portion being contiguously formed at said second end of said body, said end portion being movable from a first position to a second position; and

a strap member, said strap member being secured to said end portion, said strap member configured to surroundably mount said end portion, said strap member operable to maintain said end portion in said second position.

2. The ski protection device that is configured to inhibit debris from contacting a ski during transport as recited in claim **1**, wherein said body further includes an end member, said end member being integrally formed on said first end of said body, said end member being manufactured from a heavier material than said body.

3. The ski protection device that is configured to inhibit debris from contacting a ski during transport as recited in claim **2**, wherein in said second position said end portion is folded over against said body proximate said second end thereof wherein said end portion is adjacent said body.

4. The ski protection device that is configured to inhibit debris from contacting a ski during transport as recited in claim **3**, wherein said second portion of said body has a width that is greater than a width of said first portion of said body.

5. The ski protection device that is configured to inhibit debris from contacting a ski during transport as recited in claim **4**, wherein said body is manufactured from nylon.

6. The ski protection device that is configured to inhibit debris from contacting a ski during transport as recited in claim **5**, wherein the ski protection device facilitates an ability to transport a ski stored in the ski protection device on a conventional roof rack while a ski is disposed within the ski protection device.

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